me. I cannot imagine a people endowed with such bed-rock strength going under.'[1] In 1954, he made a highly publicized trip to China, was greeted by large crowds, and met Chairman of the Communist Party Mao Zedong and Prime Minister Zhou Enlai. When Zhou visited India in 1960, Indian crowds cheered, 'Hindi Chini bhai bhai!' – Indians and Chinese are brothers! – as he drove through the streets. Two years later, though, India and China were at war. India lost the war, and despite the withdrawal of Chinese troops from most of the areas they had captured, the relationship between Asia's giants never fully recovered. Countries fight and become friends, but India and China, sixty years after fighting a short war, are still not friends, as the bloody encounter in Galwan showed.

India and China are not friends for four key reasons: deep-seated differences over their *perceptions* of each other, their territorial *perimeters*, and their strategic *partnerships* with the big powers, as well as the asymmetry of *power* between them. The two societies' perceptions of each other, especially influential Chinese perceptions of India going back to the nineteenth century, have been negative. This may in part account for why India and China cannot agree on their perimeters – their borderlands. Negative perceptions of each other and profound differences over their perimeters are compounded by the fact that they have never been strategic partners. They have both partnered the Soviet Union/Russia and the US at various times but have never been in partnership with each other and have no history of working closely together. Their differences might not have mattered had it not been for the power gap between them, which particularly since the early 1990s has grown relentlessly in China's favour. As a result of the gap, India cannot concede, for fear of appearing weak, and China will not concede, as it does not see the need to do so.

Are there other factors that bear on their relationship? What about a fifth P – Pakistan – which is often identified as a source of conflict? Pakistani Prime Minister Yusuf Gilani rather blushingly described his country's friendship with China as 'higher than mountains, deeper than the ocean, stronger than steel and sweeter than honey'. The quasi-alliance between the two powers clearly irks India, which sees Islamabad as a pawn in Beijing's